

Cybersecurity for SME Employees

Module 4.5 – Practical Data Security Measures

1 Objective

Provide employees with actionable data security measures they can apply immediately in their daily work to protect sensitive company and customer information.

2 Introduction

Data security isn't just about policies and software—it's about everyday actions. This module covers simple yet powerful practices every employee should follow to secure digital and physical data.

3 1. Encryption Basics

- **What it is:** Encryption converts data into a coded format that only authorized users can read.
- **Why it matters:** If data is stolen, encryption makes it unreadable to attackers.
- **What to do:**
 - Use company-provided tools for encrypting emails and files.
 - Never send unencrypted sensitive data over public channels.

4 2. Secure Deletion of Data

- **What it is:** Deleting a file doesn't mean it's gone—it can often be recovered.
- **Best practices:**
 - Use secure wipe tools approved by IT for sensitive files.
 - Shred physical documents instead of throwing them in the trash.

5 3. File and Folder Permissions

- Restrict access to files based on role and need-to-know.
- Avoid using shared folders without proper permission settings.

- Regularly review access lists and report unusual access behavior.

6 4. Physical Security Measures

- Lock your screen when away from your desk.
- Store printed confidential materials in locked cabinets.
- Don't leave laptops or USB drives unattended in public or shared spaces.

7 5. Device Hygiene

- Keep operating systems and software updated.
- Use antivirus software and allow automatic scans.
- Avoid downloading unverified apps or plugins.

8 6. Safe Cloud and App Usage

- Only use company-approved cloud services and applications.
- Avoid syncing work data to personal cloud accounts or devices.
- Log out of services when not in use, especially on shared devices.

9 7. Backup Awareness

- Ensure important files are regularly backed up to secure company servers or cloud.
- Never disable backup services.
- Know the restore procedures in case of data loss.

10 Conclusion

Strong data security doesn't require advanced skills—it requires awareness and discipline. By applying these everyday practices, every employee can help build a secure and resilient organization.